PROMISE & PRACTICE · DEEP DIVE · SOURCE ANALYSIS

Sherman's March to the Sea

Four Voices, One March · Point-of-View

Name: _____ **Period:** _____ **Date:** _____

WHAT I CAN DO TODAY I can read primary sources about Sherman's March to the Sea, weigh who made each one and why, and use evidence to answer historical questions.

Directions. Sherman's march meant something completely different depending on where you stood when it passed. Read each account below and write who most likely said it. Word bank — use each once: (A) A Georgia planter · (B) A Union soldier · (C) A freed person · (D) General Sherman

THE SOURCES

YOUR WORK

ACCOUNT 1

"We are not only fighting hostile armies, but a hostile people, and must make old and young feel the hard hand of war." — Who most likely said it? ____

ACCOUNT 2

"They burned the gin house and drove off every hog and horse we owned. Forty years of work, gone in a single afternoon." — Who most likely said it? ____

ACCOUNT 3

"When the blue coats came down the road, we left the field and followed them. Nobody had to tell us we were free." — Who most likely said it? ____

ACCOUNT 4

"We lived off the land the whole way to Savannah. Hard marching, and little sleep — but the men were never in higher spirits." — Who most likely said it? ____

HISTORIAN'S CHALLENGE

These four people lived through the same event and remember it in completely different ways. In three or four sentences, explain how a single historical event can produce such different, conflicting accounts — and what that means for a historian trying to understand what really happened.

TEACHER ANSWER KEY — Sherman's March to the Sea

Account 1: **(D) General Sherman — his own justification for 'hard war' against the Southern home front.**

Account 2: **(A) A Georgia planter — describing the destruction of a plantation's property.**

Account 3: **(C) A freed person — thousands of enslaved people freed themselves by following the army.**

Account 4: **(B) A Union soldier — foraging and high morale on the march to the sea.**

Historian's Challenge: Open response.

> *Look for a response along the lines of: "The same event can look different because..., which means a historian must..."*